



Rules — 4v4 TEAM FORMAT

X.1 Purpose and Status

The **4v4 Team Format (Format A)** is an official competitive format of IronClad Tournaments (ICT), designed for structured team-based play in *Company of Heroes 3*.

This format is currently designated as **Testing Phase**. ICT reserves the right to adjust rules, structure, and procedures between events to ensure operational efficiency and competitive integrity.

All standard ICT regulations, including the **Player Participation Agreement (PPA)**, remain fully enforceable.

This format is part of the broader IronClad competitive ecosystem, designed to integrate with recurring tournaments and long-term player reward systems.

X.2 Team Composition and Registration

X.2.1 Team Structure

Each team must consist of:

- **4 starting players (mandatory)**

Substitute players are **not permitted** in the 4v4 format.

X.2.2 Registration Requirements

Teams must submit:

- Team name
- Complete roster
- Designated Team Captain

For platform registration (Battlefy):

- Only the **Team Captain** is required to register
- The Captain is the official representative for:
 - Official communications
 - Match reporting

All players must:

- Be members of the ICT Discord server

- Meet all eligibility requirements outlined in the ICT Rulebook
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X.2.3 Roster Lock

- Rosters are **locked at the start of the tournament**
 - No additions or changes are permitted after the event begins
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X.3 Match Format

For clarity:

- A "match" refers to a Best of Three (Bo3) series between two teams
- A "round" refers to a stage of the tournament (e.g., Quarterfinal, Semifinal)
 - All matches are played in **Best of Three (Bo3)**

Teams must be prepared to proceed with consecutive games within a series without unnecessary delay.

This format is mandatory to ensure competitive balance, allowing each team to compete with preferred factions.

Teams are required to complete the full series within the designated match window.

The match window is defined by the official tournament schedule communicated via ICT channels. If a series cannot be completed within the designated match window, ICT Admins reserve the right to:

- Award the match based on current game progression
- Declare a forfeit
- Issue a split or administrative decision at their discretion

Failure to do so may result in **administrative decisions**.

ICT reserves the right to modify the match format (e.g., Bo1) in cases of operational or technical necessity.

X.3.1 Tournament Structure (Single Elimination)

For events with a standard number of teams, ICT may adopt a Single Elimination format.

In a Single Elimination format:

- The tournament is divided into rounds (e.g., Quarterfinals, Semifinals, Final)
- Each round consists of matches played in Best of Three (Bo3)

A match consists of up to 3 games:

- The team that wins 2 games wins the match

Losing a match results in immediate elimination from the tournament.

Winning teams advance to the next round until a final winner is determined.

This format is used to ensure:

- Efficient tournament progression
- Competitive clarity
- Scalable event structure

X.3.2 Tournament Structure (Round Robin)

For events with a limited number of registered teams, ICT may adopt a Round Robin format.

In a Round Robin format:

- Each team plays against all other teams once
- All matches are played in Best of Three (Bo3), in accordance with Section X.3

The final standings are determined based on total match wins.

The team with the highest number of match wins at the end of all scheduled matches is declared the winner of the event.

In the event of a tie, the following tie-breakers apply in order:

1. Head-to-head result between tied teams
2. Game difference (total games won vs. lost across all matches)
3. Administrative decision or additional match at ICT discretion

This format is primarily used during the Test Phase to ensure:

- Maximum participation
- Competitive fairness
- Operational flexibility

ICT reserves the right to select the most appropriate tournament structure based on the number of registered teams.

X.3.3 Faction Selection (Open Pool)

NOTE: Mirror matches are NOT permitted, as players must play from opposing sides (Axis vs Allies).

- **3.3.1** No Locked Factions: Players are **NOT** required to pre-register a specific faction. They have access to the full roster of armies during the event.
- **3.3.2** The Two-Side Rule: While players can choose any specific army, they must strictly adhere

to the Side Restrictions (Axis vs. Allies) determined by the match flow.

- Allied Pool: US Forces (USF), British Forces (UKF).
- Axis Pool: Wehrmacht (WEHR), Deutsches Afrikakorps (DAK).

3.4 Start of Match (The Roll-Off) Admins are not required to be present. Players resolve the starting choices in the # **4v4-Tournament-hub** channels using the **Dice Bot**.

NOTE: only **Team Captain** is allowed to roll dice, the final result is valid for the all team.

- **3.4.1** The Command: Both Team Captain must type the command /r and then manually type 2d6 in the message box. This simulates rolling 2 dice with 6 faces, and the result will be shown.
- **3.4.2** The Winner: The player with the higher combined number wins the decision. Tie-Breaker: If the result is a tie, both players must reroll again.
- **3.4.3** The Choice: The Winner chooses ONE of the following:
 - Option A: Pick Side (Play as Axis or Allies).
 - Option B: Pick Map (from the Active Pool).

Who lost takes the remaining option.

Note: The tournament map pool consists of all official 1v1 maps available in Company of Heroes 3. Maps outside pool can be picked only if both players agree on it.

3.5 Match Flow (Best of 3)

- **3.5.1** Game 1: Played according to the choices made in Rule 3.2
- **3.5.2** Game 2 (The Swap): Side Swap: Players **MUST SWAP** sides. (Player A moves to Allies, Player B moves to Axis).
Free Selection: Players may choose any faction from their new side.
 - **Note:** A player who played Wehrmacht in Game 1 is not forced to play USF in Game 2. They can pick USF or UKF freely.
 - **Map:** The Loser of Game 1 selects the map.
- **3.5.3** Game 3 (The Tie-Breaker): A new roll-off is conducted following the procedure in Rule 3.2
The winner of the roll-off chooses either:
 - Option A: Pick Side (Axis or Allies)
 - Option B: Pick Map (from the active map pool)

The loser takes the remaining option.

X.4 Scheduling and Match Start

X.4.1 Coordination

- Teams must contact opponents in a timely manner
- Teams must be fully ready at the official match start time

X.4.2 Match Start and Readiness

The tournament begins once the official bracket is published.

No separate check-in is required.

By participating, teams confirm that all players are available and ready to compete at the scheduled match time.

Teams must:

- Be present and ready at match start
- Contact their opponents promptly after bracket release

If a team is not ready at match start:

- The team must:
 - Use 1 AI (Expert difficulty), or
 - Forfeit the match

Failure to comply may result in:

- Default loss
- Additional penalties at admin discretion

X.5 Player Presence and AI Regulations

X.5.1 Minimum Player Requirement

- A minimum of **3 active players** is required to start a match

X.5.2 AI Usage

- Teams with 3 players may use:
 - **1 AI (Expert difficulty)** as a replacement

X.5.3 Restrictions

The following are strictly prohibited:

- Starting a match with fewer than 3 players
 - Using AI when 4 eligible players are available
 - Substituting missing players with unregistered participants
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X.5.4 Competitive Acknowledgment

By participating, teams acknowledge that:

- AI behavior is inherently unpredictable and is considered a core element of the format
- AI performance is part of the testing phase

AI-related outcomes are **not valid grounds** for:

- Match disputes
 - Remake requests
 - Formal complaints
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X.5.5 AI Round Integrity Rule

If a player is absent at match start:

- The player may be replaced by **1 AI (Expert difficulty)**
- The AI must remain for the entire duration of the game

The following are not permitted:

- Replacing the AI mid-game
- Reintroducing the player during an active match

The absent player may return in subsequent games within the series.

X.6 Player Loss During a Match

If a team falls below 3 active players during a match:

- The match is **automatically awarded** to the opposing team

The opposing team must:

- Notify an admin immediately
- Provide supporting evidence (e.g., screenshot)

Failure to report the issue promptly may result in the match result being upheld or the claim being disregarded.

X.7 Disconnections and Technical Issues

All standard ICT rules regarding disconnections apply.

In the 4v4 format, administrative decisions are based on overall competitive context, including:

- Map control
- Victory Points (VP)
- Army strength
- Current game state

All admin rulings are **final and binding**.

X.8 Competitive Integrity

X.8.1 Player Eligibility

- Only players listed on the official roster are eligible to compete
 - The use of external or unregistered players is strictly prohibited
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X.8.2 Rule Enforcement and Abuse

Teams are expected to make a genuine effort to field a complete roster.

Any attempt to:

- Exploit AI rules
- Manipulate player availability
- Circumvent roster restrictions

May result in penalties up to and including **disqualification**.

X.9 Team Responsibilities

Each team is responsible for:

- Player attendance
- Match readiness
- Internal coordination

Player absence does **not** justify delays, exceptions, or rescheduling.

X.10 Format Limitations (Test Phase)

As a testing-phase format, ICT may adjust:

- AI regulations
- Match structure
- Scheduling systems

All changes will occur **between tournaments only**, never during an active competition.

X.11 Final Authority

All matters related to the 4v4 format fall under ICT administrative authority.

All decisions are:

- Final
- Binding
- Not subject to appeal